

FAQs

How does MODAF help to ensure Model Coherency?

The MOD Architectural Framework has been designed to be highly integrated. Key to this is the role played by the MODAF Meta-Model. Integration has been achieved at the view presentation level and the data level.

Because an architectural description is inevitably multi-faceted, modelling coherence is an essential ingredient of the model-driven development approach. The framework supports the achievement of modelling coherence in a number of ways that are described in this article.

Temporal Coherence

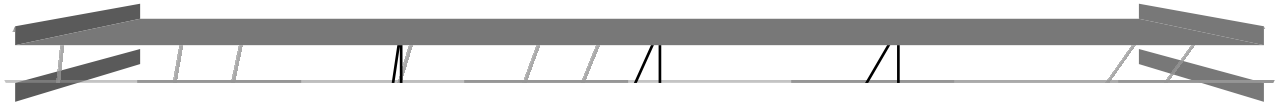
The framework has a much richer temporal component than other architectural frameworks because the representation of time (in the enterprise sense) is addressed by two viewpoints, the Strategic and Acquisition Viewpoints, that are unique to MODAF.

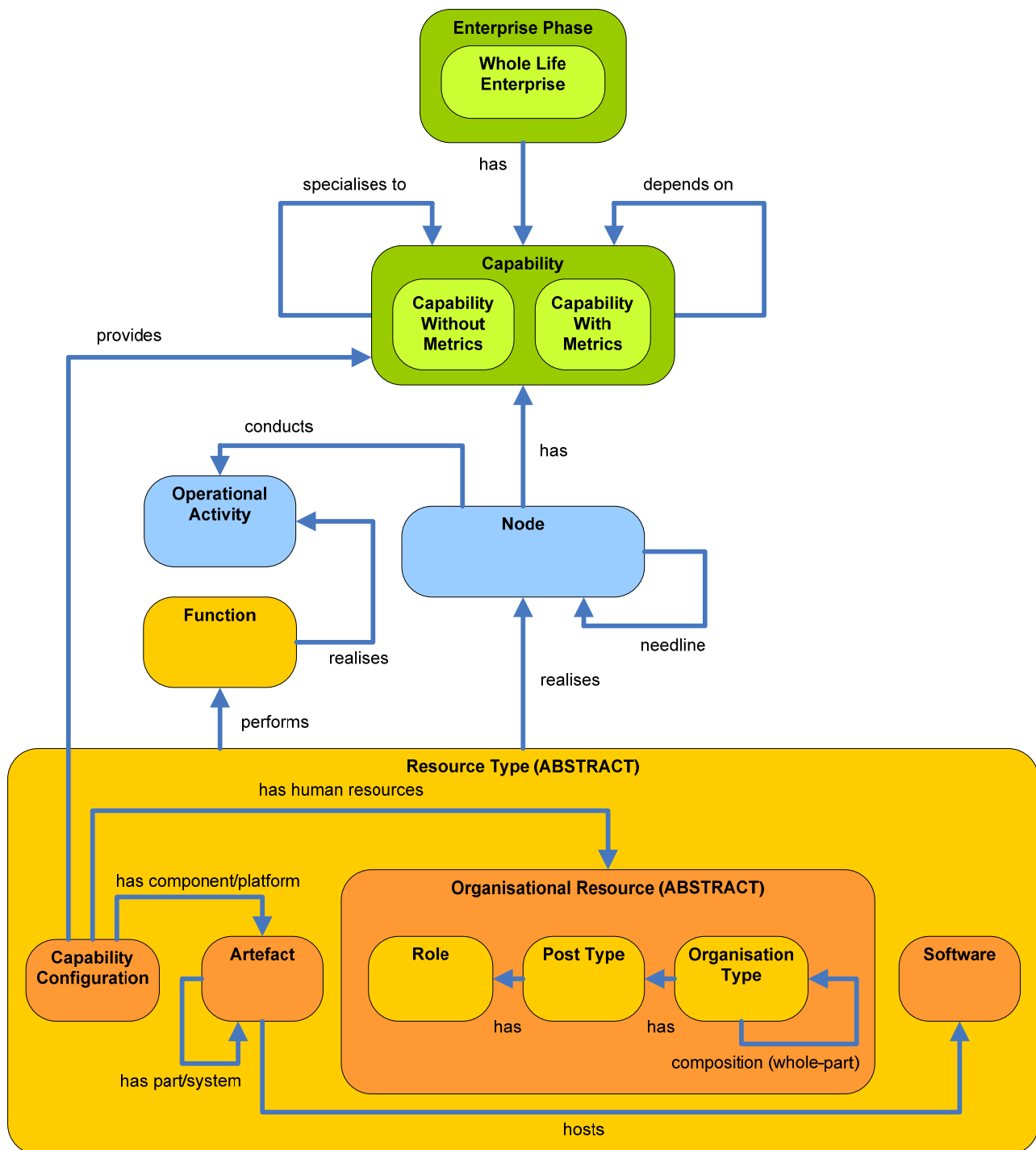
Temporal coherence is based on integration of these two viewpoints, which is illustrated below.



Horizontal Integration

Horizontal integration refers to the achievement of modelling coherence within a Viewpoint (or modelling layer). This is based on the support to view production provided by a coherent set of data objects underpinned by the MODAF Meta-Model. This is illustrated below.





Simplified Representation of Key M3 Concepts and Relationships

Architecture Governance

While modelling coherence is supported by use of MODAF, especially use of the MODAF Meta-Model, it should be recognised that architecting within the MOD environment is inevitably a collaborative activity. This implies that architecture governance is needed to ensure success. This is the responsibility of DG Info, who is discharging this responsibility through the Enterprise Architecture programme (within which the MODAF development programme sits).

The primary elements of governance relate to the direction to the MOD community to actually use MODAF, arrangements for assurance of architecture products, and support to the MOD community

from an architectural repository (see *EA policy* – link tbd). The Meta-Model (link tbd) and MODAF Ontology (link tbd) are technical enablers that support the governance arrangements.

Disciplined application of MODAF (within the parameters prescribed by governance) through collaborative architecting is essential if the vision of NEC is to be achieved.